



5G spectrum auction begins!

India's 5G spectrum auction started recently. Jio and Airtel are the major players to look out for.
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Gaming Phones

Just get a console

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Have you ever seen a person setting their hard-earned money ablaze? No? You haven't seen someone buy a gaming phone? Well, if you haven't, then you've saved yourself from a world of misery. If you have, though, then that is what burning your money looks like. Gaming phones are the worst category of smartphones to exist, matched closely by gimmicky folding devices. Those look like ugly butterflies that people spend money on for a reason I don't comprehend.

Let's come back to the topic of gaming phones before I spiral off and burst a vein. What do people see in gaming phones when buying them? Both literally and figuratively. They have a bright, bulky, and light-up logo-laden design that screams – I AM A GAMER!!!! Who would want that? I am a fan of reading, but I do not wear a T-shirt with book covers printed on it. I wear a beautiful monotone black suit that makes me look presentable. I pack performance, but I do not show it. Unlike gaming phones and their owners. Do you know what they look like? Circus clowns. Pulling off gim-

micky movements and stunts that are of no real value while dressing like a rainbow spilt some of its unused colours on them.

Many might argue that their displays are great. Really? Sell that argument to someone from 2014 who had not seen a high refresh rate display on the phone until a 'gaming' phone introduced them to it. Nowadays, almost every phone on the market has a high refresh display. The one that used to be a selling point of these overpriced sandwiches of glass and silicon. Take the high refresh rate out of the equation, and their displays would look like they are from an old device.

Talking about the things that are terrible about gaming phones, I am reminded of their cameras. What do these people think when making a gaming phone's camera set up and software?! They are absolute garbage. Even if, someone gets to the top spot in a tournament using a gaming phone, they will not be able to take half decent pictures of themselves winning the trophy! All that they will have from one of the best days of their lives will be a collection of subpar pictures that look like a blob of pixels on a screen. You do not want to be that person.

There's still a lot left for me to talk about. The most important of which is the performance of these devices. To prevent my house from being burnt

down by the fans of this type of smart-phone, I ran a few tests to prove my point. I took three devices, a pseudo-gaming phone, an actual "gaming" phone that the marketing people go on rambling about, and a normal person's everyday carry. All three had the exact same chipset, which was the SD 888. And here's how their results were in the test (AnTuTu 8.0) that I ran:

Pseudo Gaming Phone	827163
'Gaming' Phone	825825
Normal Smartphone	815612

The 'Gaming' phone may have inched slightly ahead in terms of the numbers. But when factoring in the cost and the rest of the things like the camera performance, these numbers start looking pretty bad. In terms of just getting the sheer bang for your buck, which you should, given that the recession is on the horizon and indulging in unnecessary expenses isn't wise, the gaming phone falls behind by a huge margin. Do not be fooled by the numbers that the marketing agencies put out for the gaming devices. They are achieved with those huge bulky accessories attached, which, trust me, you will never even pull out of the box after that initial honeymoon period with your device. Because they are just inconvenient.

Adding to it is the lack of battery management options available in most of these devices. On the spec sheet, it would look like they have higher than average battery life. However, once they start sucking the juice out, the 'gaming' phones never stop. They only take a breather once you are left with a sub-5 per cent battery, stuck on a random highway in the middle of nowhere in a broken car.

There's a lot more to say that I am holding back because my overlords give me only so much space. But know that my commentary is not over. There's a lot more to say. If not today, I shall emerge some other time and tell the world about how much of a poor investment gaming phones are. **d**